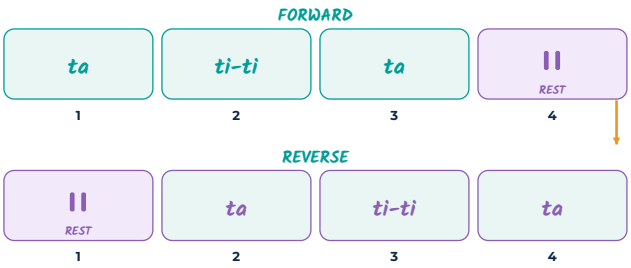
MODULE 08

Focus & Memory

Keep track of cues, words, patterns, and landmarks.



Four-Event Memory Chain



Rhythm Backwards

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

71 Four-Event Memory Chain

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80 Recall and Rebuild

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 071

Four-Event Memory Chain

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Four cards: clap, tap, speak, rest.

Remember a short sequence of different musical actions.



CLAP | TAP | SPEAK | REST

TURN THE CARDS OVER AND RECALL

? | ? | ? | ?

See the four actions, turn the cards over, then recall the same order.

1. Show a sequence of the four cards and perform it together once at a steady pace.
2. Turn the cards over and repeat the actions in the same order.
3. Reveal the cards to check, then change only one position and repeat the process.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The order stays correct without making the tempo faster.

COMMON TRAP

Changing several card positions at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two cards first and allow a partner to point at remembered positions.

ACTIVITY 072

Missing Word Rehearsal

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / One familiar lyric line.

Retrieve important lyric words without depending on the page.

READ	We	sing	together	today
HIDE	We	sing	_____	today
RECALL	We	____	together	_____

Read the complete original line, hide a key word, then retrieve it in rhythm.

1. Read and speak the complete line together, identifying its key words.
2. Hide one key word and let the choir supply it in the spoken rhythm.
3. Hide two words, then sing the full line from memory before checking the original text.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The missing words return in the correct place and order.

COMMON TRAP

Hiding too much text before one word is secure.

MAKE IT WORK

Leave first letters visible or use picture cues for key words.

ACTIVITY 073

Listen Before You Echo

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Director and a three-note phrase.

Delay the response until the whole model has been heard.

MODEL / LISTEN

1 2 1

RESPONSE / ECHO

1 2 1

wait for cue

A raised hand keeps the group listening. Echo only after the waiting beat and response cue.

1. *Explain that a raised hand means listen and an open palm means echo.*
2. *Model a short phrase while the hand stays raised; release the echo cue after one silent beat.*
3. *Vary the phrase and the waiting beat so the choir cannot simply copy immediately.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No one starts before the echo cue, even when the model is familiar.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing immediately because the phrase is familiar.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken words first and add melody later.

ACTIVITY 074

Two Cues, Two Responses

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Pointing gesture and open-hand gesture.

Hold two simple musical instructions in working memory.



POINT → Speak "ready"



OPEN HAND → Sing "loo"

Learn one mapping first. After a rest, swap meanings and slow down.

1. Agree that pointing means speak 'ready' and an open hand means sing a gentle 'loo'.
2. Show six mixed cues slowly, allowing one clear response to each.
3. After a rest, swap the meanings and practise again at a slower pace.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir responds to the current rule rather than the previous one.

COMMON TRAP

Swapping meanings before the first rule is secure.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the first mapping throughout for groups who need more processing time.

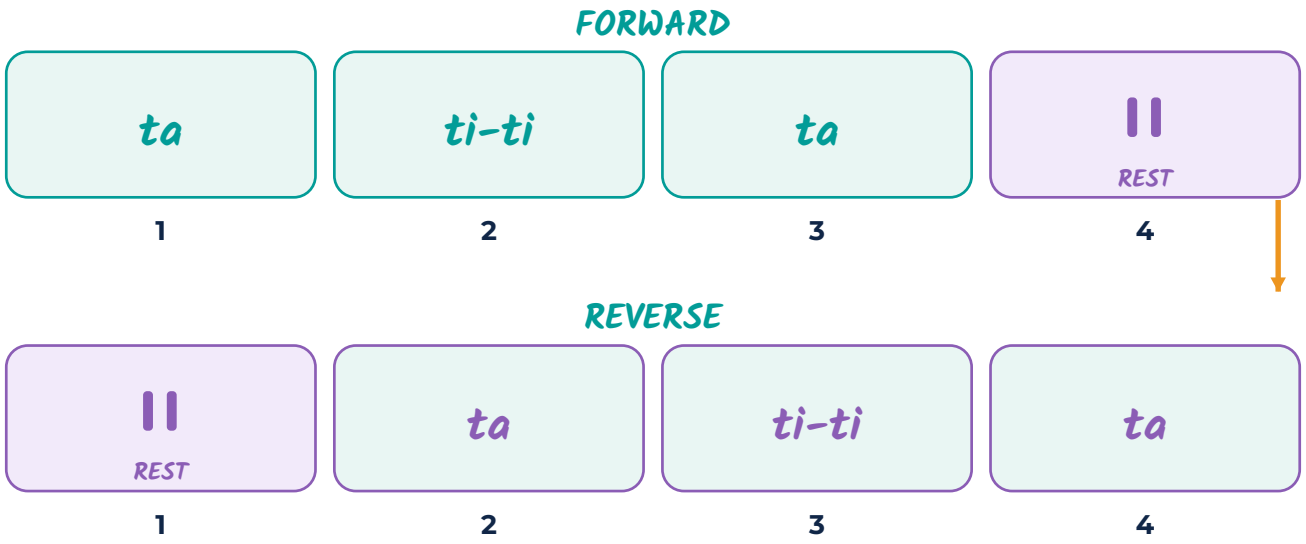
ACTIVITY 075

Rhythm Backwards

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / Four cards with one or two sounds each.

Reorder a short rhythm deliberately rather than by habit.



Reverse the cards, not the two sounds inside "ti-ti".

1. *Show four beats: ta, ti-ti, ta, rest; speak the sequence forward.*
2. *Read the cards from right to left, keeping each card's own sounds unchanged.*
3. *Perform forward then reversed versions, stopping to compare the order rather than racing.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The card order reverses while the internal 'ti-ti' stays together.

COMMON TRAP

Reversing the sounds inside a ti-ti card.

MAKE IT WORK

Use three cards and point through them while the group responds.

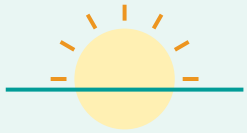
ACTIVITY 076

Lyric Landmark Map

Focus & Memory

7 minutes / Text of one song.

Recall a longer song through meaningful section cues.



VERSE / sunrise



REFRAIN / together



VERSE / path

One meaningful cue for each real section

Illustrative landmarks: choose your own meaningful word for each real section.

1. Choose one memorable word or image for each section and write them in order.
2. Sing section openings while looking only at that landmark list.
3. Remove one landmark at a time and check the text after the attempt, correcting gently.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers can find the next section without restarting the whole song.

COMMON TRAP

Using section cues that mean nothing to the singers.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the full list visible and practise only two sections today.

ACTIVITY 077

Silent Singing Window

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / A well-known four-bar phrase.

Keep the musical sequence moving during a brief silent passage.



The musical sequence keeps moving

Bars 1–2 aloud, bar 3 in the mind, bar 4 aloud in the correct place.

1. Sing the first two bars aloud at an easy tempo.
2. Continue the next bar silently in your mind while watching the beat, then sing the final bar aloud.
3. Check whether both pitch and text rejoin in the right place; shorten the silent section if not.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir returns together at the expected word and note.

COMMON TRAP

Stopping the musical sequence during the silent bar.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep tapping the beat or let the director mouth the text silently.

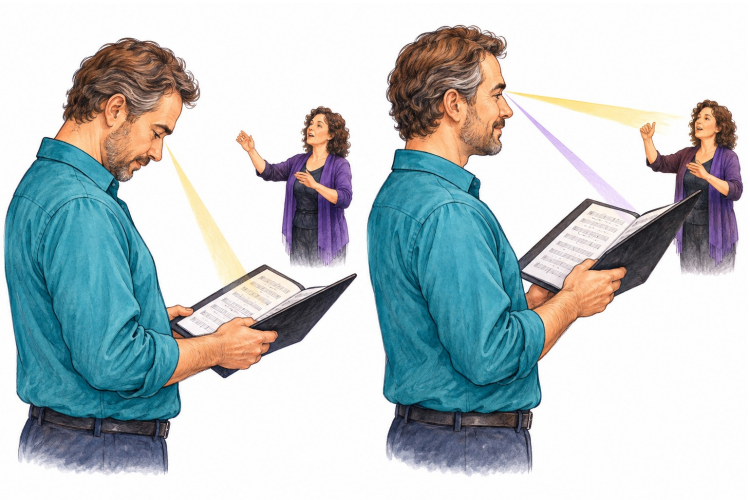
ACTIVITY 078

Score-to-Eyes Transfer

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / One two-bar phrase.

Remember a small unit long enough to watch the director.



READ ONE UNIT

LOOK FOR THE CUE

SING FROM MEMORY

Remember a small unit, look up for its cue, sing, then glance back if needed.

1. Read and sing the first short unit while looking at the score.
2. Look up and sing the same unit from memory, allowing a glance back afterwards.
3. Join two units while planning exactly where it is safe to look up.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Looking up does not cause a lost word or missed entrance.

COMMON TRAP

Looking up before a small unit is remembered.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a one-word unit or a large-print cue card near the director.

ACTIVITY 079

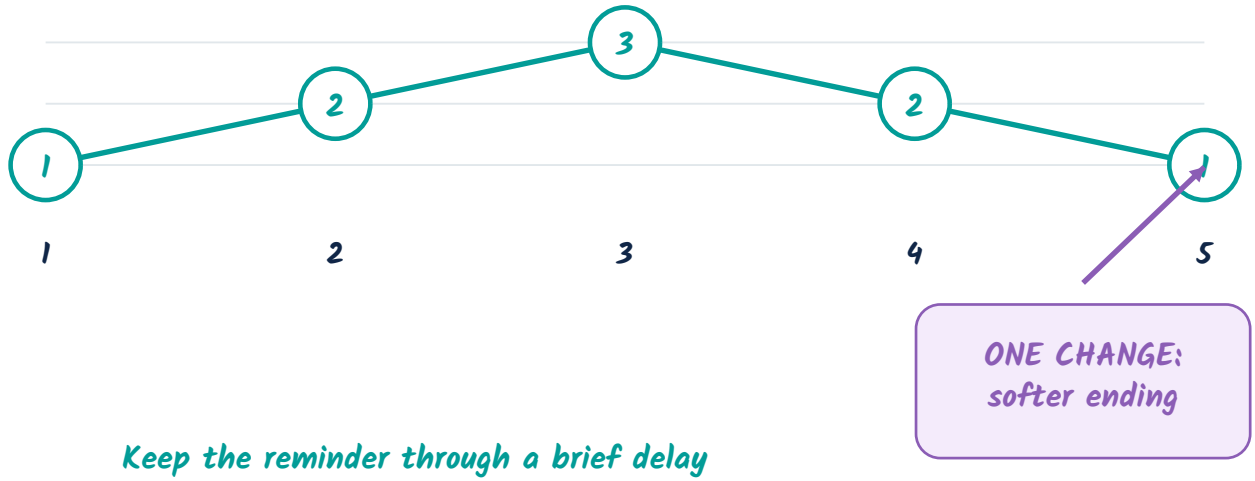
One-Change Challenge

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / One phrase and a written change.

Track a single revision in a familiar passage.

Same notes, words and pulse



Keep the reminder through a brief delay

Change only the ending. Keep notes, words and pulse the same.

1. Sing the phrase as usual, then announce one change such as a softer ending.
2. Repeat with only that change; listeners state whether it happened at the correct place.
3. Write the change into the score and sing again after a brief unrelated task.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The new instruction survives the delay without disturbing other features.

COMMON TRAP

Changing notes, words and dynamics all at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the reminder card visible rather than relying on memory alone.

ACTIVITY 080

Recall and Rebuild

Focus & Memory

7 minutes / A familiar song with clear section labels.

Recover a passage after an interruption without starting from the beginning.

STOP
Pause calmly

→

NEXT WORD + NOTE
Find the landmark

→

PREPARE
See the gesture

→

RESTART HERE
Rejoin in time

Restart at an internal landmark instead of returning to the beginning.

1. Stop at a planned point and ask singers to name the next word and starting note quietly to a partner.
2. Give a clear preparation and restart exactly at that point.
3. Repeat from another landmark, then practise the least secure restart once more.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir can restart from at least two internal landmarks.

COMMON TRAP

Restarting the whole song after every interruption.

MAKE IT WORK

Supply the starting note and first word before the cue.